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# Before You Ask for a Flowmeter Quote, Prepare These 8 Site Details

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Ruby L. | Velomac Flow Meter



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Many flowmeter inquiries start like this:

“Please quote one flowmeter.”

I understand why buyers do this. People are busy. Procurement needs a price. The project may already be delayed. Nobody wants to write a long technical story just to begin a conversation.

But in flow measurement, a short inquiry can easily produce a weak recommendation.

The supplier may ask follow-up questions. Or worse, the supplier may not ask enough questions and simply quote a model that looks acceptable on paper.

That is where problems begin.

At Velomac, we manufacture several flowmeter technologies: vortex, electromagnetic, turbine, thermal mass, V-Cone, swirl, balanced differential pressure, and ultrasonic. The reason is simple. Industrial applications are different, and the wrong principle can create trouble even if the price looks attractive.

# Before You Ask for a Flowmeter Quote

Send These Site Details



flowmeter

So if you want a useful flowmeter quotation, here is what I would send first.

## 1. The fluid

Is it liquid, gas, or steam? If it is liquid, is it conductive? Is it clean, dirty, corrosive, viscous, or mixed with solids? If it is gas, is it dry or wet? If it is steam, what are the operating conditions?

This one detail can immediately change the technology direction.

## 2. The flow range

Do not send only the pipe size. Pipe size is not the same as flow range.

A good inquiry should include minimum, normal, and maximum flow if possible. Many measurement problems come from choosing a meter around a nominal point while the real operation moves much wider.

## 3. Pressure and temperature

These conditions affect materials, structure, compensation, and long-term reliability. A flowmeter that looks fine at room temperature may not be the right choice for a high-temperature or high-pressure line.

#### 4. Pipe information



Send pipe size, pipe material, connection type, and available straight pipe length before and after the meter position.

This matters more than many buyers expect. Limited straight run can push the discussion toward certain structures, installation corrections, or alternative technologies such as V-Cone, balanced differential pressure, or ultrasonic approaches depending on the case.

#### 5. Installation limits

Can the pipe be cut? Is the site a new project or retrofit? Is shutdown time limited? Is there vibration? Is the meter position easy to access? Does the display need to be local or remote?

The best flowmeter on paper can become a poor choice if the site cannot install or maintain it properly.

#### 6. Signal and communication

Tell the supplier what the control system needs. Across different Velomac product lines, the brochure lists options such as 4–20 mA, pulse, RS485, HART, and Modbus depending on model. The exact requirement should be confirmed before ordering.

#### 7. Calibration expectation

For industrial buyers, calibration should not be treated as a final document only.

Ask what calibration is possible, what traceability is available, and how the factory verifies the meter. Velomac's brochure describes gas and liquid flow calibration standards and 100% in-house calibration. For us, this is part of making the number credible.

## 8. The real pain point

This is my favorite part of the inquiry.

Tell us what you are trying to solve.

Is the old reading unstable? Is energy consumption unclear? Is compressed air usage being estimated? Is steam balance difficult? Is maintenance access painful? Is pressure loss a concern? Is the site trying to reduce manual checking?

When we know the pain point, we can think like engineers instead of only quoting like sellers.

A better flowmeter inquiry does not need to be beautiful. It just needs to be honest.

The buyer does not need to know every answer before contacting a supplier. But the more real site information we receive, the better we can match the technology, structure, material, output, and calibration approach.

In industrial measurement, a fast quote is not always a good quote.

A good quote is the one that understands the process before naming the meter.

Flowmeter Selection +

Industrial Measurement +

Procurement +

Process Control +



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**Written by Ruby L. | Velomac Flow Meter**

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Overseas executive at Velomac Flow Meter. Practical notes on flow measurement, selection, steam, gas, liquids and energy loss blind spots.

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